

Stourbridge Lion brought the steam age to the American shores in 1829, on the Delaware and Hudson line. Around this time, Stephenson was appointed as engineer to oversee the construction of a 64-km railway line connecting Liverpool and Manchester. The famous Rainhill Trials were held to decide which locomotives would run on the line. There were several competitors, but George and Robert Stephenson's *Rocket* took home the glory, running at 58 km/h. The machine went on to become almost a blueprint for future locomotives until the end of the steam era. *Rocket's* success led to a flurry of construction as lines were laid and locomotives built, on both sides of the Atlantic. The *Tom Thumb*, an American-built machine, built by American philanthropist Peter Cooper, made its debut on the Baltimore and Ohio Railroad, marking the beginning of the railway revolution that would change not just the US, but the world as well.



▲ A silver medal depicting steam locomotive *De Hoop* (Hope) of Netherlands.

Around the world

The mid-19th century was of particular significance in the history of the railways. The construction of railway lines, a crucial hallmark of development, began at a furious pace across Europe as tracks connected cities across the continent providing access to even the most inaccessible of places. The first line connecting Dublin and Kingstown opened in Ireland in 1834. Germany was close behind as Leipzig and Dresden were linked, making it the country's first long-distance line in